605.486 – Android Development

Module 6a
Instance Data

Saving Data

- Rotate Activity -> instance is destroyed
- Any member data is gone!
- Standard Views w/ IDs automatically saved

Bundles

- Android uses “Bundles” to hold data
  - Passing via intents
  - Saving instance data
- Bundles can hold
  - Primitives
  - Serializable
  - Parcelable

Instance Data Bundle

- onSaveInstanceData(Bundle)
  - Called during “pause” transition
- onRestoreInstanceData(Bundle)
  - Called during “start” transition
- onCreate(Bundle)
  - Passed null first time; passed saved bundle subsequent times
  - Allows saved data to be used during creation

Serializable vs. Parcelable Objects

- Objects must be Serializable or Parcelable to save
- Serializable is easy but slow
- Parcelable is more work but more efficient
  - describeContents: distinguish between sibling classes
    - Usually return 0
  - writeToParcel: writes data for this object
  - public static Parcelable.Creator<Type> CREATOR
    - newArray – creates instance of array of Type
    - createFromParcel – creates instance